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Agent 001



Intel Core i3 6100 or AMD A8-7600?

Hi, I am planning on buying a new computer and was checking out different PC configurations. It seems I'll be going with the Intel Core i3 6100 or the AMD A8-7600 but I'm not sure which one to buy. This is going to be used for little bit of everything so I need an all-rounder computer. What are your thoughts?

—Shikhar Bhatia

A Hey Shikhar, We totally understand your concern and we've looked at the two CPUs from both aspects – IGP and CPU performance. The Integrated Graphics Processor on the Intel Core i3 6100, i.e. the Intel HD 530 performs better than the R7 IGP on the AMD A8-7600. The Intel Core i3 6100 is ahead in



Intel Core i3 6100

terms of single-core and multi-core performance as well. The only downside is that Skylake processors don't come with their own coolers and you'll have to invest in a third-party CPU cooler.

Firepower and battery-power

Hi Agent001! Greetings from Noida! I am a student of class 9th. I want to buy a laptop in the range of ₹30-40k for my personal use. Please guide me to the best possible buy which may include 4-8 GB RAM, DVD reader, num pad, 14-15 inch HD/FullHD, Windows 10, good battery backup, good gaming in this range. I had in mind HP or Dell models. Please suggest a laptop which is easily available in stores and please do not suggest a Chinese OEM laptop.

—Bhavya Aditya

A Hi Bhavya, Let's get some misconceptions cleared, Bhavya. You're asking for a laptop with good battery backup and good gaming performance. These are two polar opposite elements of any laptop, in the sense having a laptop with the firepower (hardware) required to play games directly impacts its battery life. For e.g., a laptop with a 15-inch screen, Core i5

processor, 8 GB RAM, NVIDIA GTX 980M graphics with 4 GB GDDR5 will eat up more battery compared to a 13-inch laptop with a Core i3 processor, 2-4 GB RAM, and NVIDIA GTX 920M graphics with 2 GB GDDR3. As a thumb rule, if you're comparing two laptops' specifications, more often than not the higher-specced laptop of the bunch will be a higher battery consumer.

Before I suggest you the two best laptops (one each from Dell and HP, as per your preference), let me tell you about another peculiarity of the laptop buying process. See, there's a sizeable difference in the laptop model numbers between online and offline stores. There is no guaranteed way for us to tell you which laptops are being sold at an electronics store near you. The vast number of laptops, across hardware generations, are now without a doubt sold online through stores like Flipkart, Amazon, Snapdeal, Ebay, etc. Why? Because these websites have hundreds of different sellers who're all competing against each other (across geographies) in terms of offerings and discounts. The consumer – which is you – benefits as a whole when you buy from an online store.



HP 15 Laptop

With that being said, here are your two laptop recommendations:

First, the HP 15. It doesn't have a discrete GPU, but comes with latest 6th generation Intel Core i3 processor (low-powered) which should help maximize your battery life to the maximum.

Second, the Dell Inspiron 15 5558. This one has a slightly better GPU with an NVIDIA 920M, but its processor is 5th generation Intel Core i3. It also costs ₹3k more than your budget. **E**

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